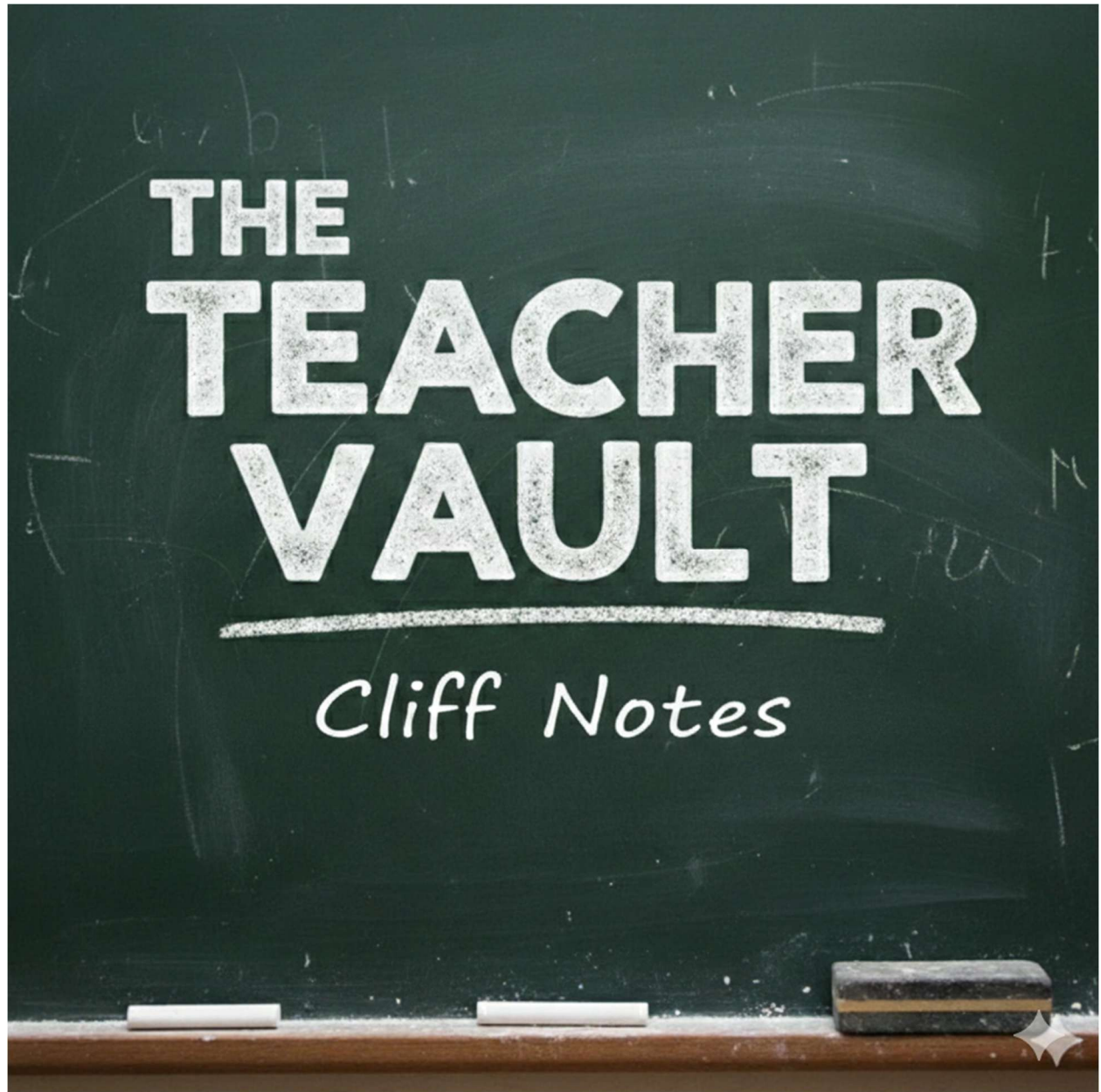


DR JEKYLL AND MR HYDE

CLIFF NOTES



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CLIFF NOTES

1. CONTEXT (What You Must Know)

- Written by **Robert Louis Stevenson** in 1886.
 - Set in **Victorian London**.
 - Reflects Victorian fears about:
 - Science and experimentation.
 - Reputation and social respectability.
 - Hidden sin and moral hypocrisy.
 - Influenced by:
 - Darwin's theory of evolution.
 - Gothic literature.
 - A **Gothic novella** exploring the darker side of human nature.
-

2. PLOT SUMMARY (Clear Overview)

- Mr Utterson, a lawyer, investigates the mysterious Mr Hyde.
 - Hyde tramples a child and later murders Sir Danvers Carew.
 - Dr Jekyll appears connected to Hyde but refuses to explain.
 - Dr Lanyon witnesses Hyde transform into Jekyll.
 - Jekyll admits he created a potion to separate good and evil within himself.
 - Hyde grows stronger and more uncontrollable.
 - Jekyll ultimately loses control and dies.
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3. MAIN CHARACTERS

Dr Henry Jekyll

- Respected scientist.
- Obsessed with separating good and evil.
- Represents repression and internal conflict.
- Tragically loses control of his darker side.

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Mr Edward Hyde

- Violent and cruel.
- Described as animalistic and primitive.
- Represents pure evil and instinct.

Mr Gabriel Utterson

- Rational and logical.
- Seeks truth.
- Represents Victorian reason and order.

Dr Lanyon

- Traditional scientist.
 - Shocked by Jekyll's experiments.
 - Represents conventional morality.
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4. KEY THEMES

Duality

- "Man is not truly one, but truly two."
- Everyone has good and evil within them.

Reputation

- Victorian society values outward respectability.
- Characters hide secrets to protect status.

Science vs Religion

- Fear of scientific experimentation.
- Danger of playing God.

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Secrecy and Isolation

- Locked doors.
- Withheld information.
- Confessions revealed only at the end.

Violence and the Primitive

- Hyde described as “troglodytic.”
 - Suggests humanity’s animalistic nature.
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5. KEY SYMBOLS

- **The Door** – Jekyll’s hidden life.
 - **Fog** – Moral confusion.
 - **The Laboratory** – Corrupt science.
 - **Hyde’s Appearance** – Moral decay made physical.
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6. STRUCTURE

- Told through multiple narrators.
 - Mystery structure — truth revealed at the end.
 - Builds suspense through withheld information.
 - Final chapter is a confession.
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7. HIGH-IMPACT QUOTES

- “Man is not truly one, but truly two.”
- “I concealed my pleasures.”
- “Something troglodytic.”
- “If he be Mr Hyde, I shall be Mr Seek.”
- “The moment I choose, I can be rid of Mr Hyde.”

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8. EXAM TIPS (Head of Year Advice)

- Always link to **Victorian context**.
 - Analyse **setting** (fog, darkness, London streets).
 - Explore **symbolism** (doors, mirrors, transformation).
 - Track Jekyll's loss of control across the novella.
 - Discuss how Stevenson builds suspense.
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9. ONE-PARAGRAPH OVERVIEW (Quick Recall)

Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde is a Gothic novella about a respected Victorian scientist who creates a potion to separate the good and evil sides of his personality. His darker alter ego, Mr Hyde, becomes increasingly violent and uncontrollable. Ultimately, Jekyll is destroyed by the very experiment he believed he could control.